
Part 1 — Their Questions, Answered

The four Home Office Written Parliamentary Questions on the Metropolitan Police’s Palantir “Unified Data Platform” trial — which the Government declined to answer — answered from the public record

Prepared for: the Office of Iqbal Mohamed MP (Dewsbury and Batley)

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Evidence: github.com/btmaffiliate/uk-data-linkage-disclosure

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Your office tabled UINs 7091, 7092, 7093 and 7202. Three drew the reply “police are operationally independent... the Home Office does not hold this information.” This document gives, for each: the verbatim question, the verbatim Government answer, and what the public record actually shows — every claim tagged [confirmed]/[inference]/[unanswered] with a source URL. This concerns the **Metropolitan Police / Palantir** policing trial only (distinct from the MoJ Splink programme in Part 2). Built from public sources; not legal advice.

Part 1 — Their questions, answered

Iqbal Mohamed MP's office tabled four Written Parliamentary Questions to the Home Office about the Metropolitan Police's Palantir "Unified Data Platform" (UDP) trial: what data went in (UIN 7092), whether the data-protection impact assessment had been re-approved by the force's Data Protection Officer (UIN 7093), whether an ethical review had been completed (UIN 7202), and what guidance governs recording and publishing supplier risk assessments when buying AI/data platforms through central frameworks (UIN 7091). The office asked precise, answerable questions about a live, controversial policing technology. The Government, in the main, did not answer them.

To three of the four, the Home Office fell back on a single formula — "Police Forces are operationally independent... the Home Office does not review their Data Protection Impact Assessments and does not hold this information" — and to the fourth it gave a generic account of cross-government procurement guidance that only partly addressed the question asked. That deflection is itself the story. But "we don't hold it" is not the same as "it isn't knowable." Below, for each question, is the verbatim question, the verbatim Government (non-)answer, what the public record actually shows (every claim tagged confirmed / inference / unanswered with a real source), and — where the record still falls silent — a plain statement of who holds the answer and the route to prise it loose. One framing point runs through all four: the headline crime-intelligence datasets (CRIS/CRIMINT, custody, stop-and-search, ANPR, gangs matrix, facial images) belong to a *separate* blocked ~£50m "Unified Operational Analytics" (UOA) contract, **not** the UDP misconduct/integrity-screening trial these questions ask about. The two must not be conflated. (Nor should any of this be confused with the MoJ Splink programme, which is unrelated.)

UIN 7092 — Categories of personal and special-category data ingested by Palantir

(a) The question (verbatim)

"To ask the Secretary of State for the Home Department, what categories of personal and special category data have been ingested by or made available to Palantir in its Unified Data Platform trial with the Metropolitan police, and whether a summary can be [placed in the Library]."

UIN 7092 — tabled by Iqbal Mohamed MP, **4 June 2026**; answered **11 June 2026** by Sarah Jones MP (Home Office). Source: <https://questions-statements-api.parliament.uk/api/writtenquestions/questions?uin=7092&house=Commons>

(b) What the Government answered (verbatim)

"Police Forces are operationally independent, and the Home Office does not review their Data Protection Impact Assessments and does not hold this information."

(c) What the public record actually shows

The Home Office explicitly disclaims holding any list. But the wider record *does* partially answer the underlying question — just not from Whitehall.

- **The UDP trial is an internal professional-standards/anti-corruption pilot ingesting the Met's own employee data, not external crime databases.** (*confirmed*) The Met frames it as data it "already lawfully holds" to identify "potential standards, welfare or cultural concerns." — <https://news.met.police.uk/news/metropolitan-police-strengthens-standards-using-technology-and-new-vetting-powers-508631>
- **Employee-data categories analysed include illness/absence levels, absences from duty and overtime patterns, drawn from HR and operational data gathered since 2024 and consolidated in Palantir Foundry.** (*confirmed*) Sickness/illness data is special-category-relevant. — <https://www.silicon.co.uk/e-regulation/surveillance/met-police-palantir-629642>
- **The tool also processed data from work mobile phones and laptops, including device geolocation** (the basis of officers' "continuous 24/7 geolocation tracking" objections), plus shift-roster IT records and declared secondary employment. (*confirmed*) — <https://www.thenerve.news/p/met-police-palantir-officer-ai-surveillance-misconduct-extension-contract-federation>
- **The contract was published on Contracts Finder as "Unified Data Platform Phase 1," ~£489,999, 1 Feb–30 Apr 2026, extended to 15 May 2026** — pitched just under the £500,000 MOPAC-scrutiny threshold. (*confirmed*) — <https://www.thenerve.news/p/met-police-palantir-officer-ai-surveillance-misconduct-extension-contract-federation>
- **CRITICAL DISTINCTION:** the crime-intelligence datasets in the question's premise (CRIS/CRIMINT, custody, stop-and-search, ANPR, gangs matrix, facial images) belong to the separate "Unified Operational Analytics" (UOA) proposal (~£25.3m + £24.8m optional ≈ £50m) for automating criminal-investigation intelligence — **not** the UDP misconduct trial. (*confirmed*) — <https://www.silicon.co.uk/e-regulation/surveillance/london-palantir-630364>
- **That larger UOA crime-intelligence deal was blocked by Sadiq Khan / the Deputy Mayor on 21 May 2026** over procurement and value-for-money breaches, with Palantir reportedly moving to sue — confirming the crime-data ambitions were a distinct, unrealised contract. The UDP misconduct pilot itself ran under a directly-awarded contract with no open competition. (*confirmed*) — <https://novaramedia.com/2026/05/21/sadiq-khan-blocks-50m-palantir-ai-deal-with-met-police/>
- A primary Met document — the Deputy Commissioner's **12 June 2026 letter on "Unified Operational Analytics"** — exists but concerns the blocked UOA deal, not the UDP trial, and could not be retrieved (HTTP 403). (*inference*) — https://www.met.police.uk/SysSiteAssets/foi-media/metropolitan-police/other_information/corporate/120626-letter-matt-jukesqpm-mpsdeputy-commissioner-dmpe-unified-operational-analytics.pdf

(d) Where the record still doesn't answer it

- No itemised, authoritative schema of the exact fields/datasets ingested into the UDP trial has been published — only broad categories. (*unanswered*)
- Whether any data formally classified as **special-category under UK GDPR Art. 9** (health/sickness, ethnicity, trade-union/Federation membership, biometrics) was processed, and under which DPA 2018 Schedule 1 lawful-basis condition, is not on the record. (*unanswered*)

- The Met withheld the **cost and scope of the extension to 15 May 2026** as "commercially sensitive." (*unanswered*)
- Whether UDP data was a stepping-stone to the blocked UOA crime datasets is unestablished. (*unanswered*)

Who holds it / route: the **Met** (it holds the DPIA, ROPA and ingestion schema) — via **FOI** to the MPS, or via the **London Assembly Police & Crime Committee / MOPAC**. The Home Office confirms it does not hold it. The 12 June UOA letter is worth obtaining directly or by FOI.

UIN 7093 — Has the DPIA been reviewed, updated and re-approved by the DPO?

(a) The question (verbatim)

"To ask the Secretary of State for the Home Department, whether the Met's Data Protection Impact Assessment of its Unified Data Platform trial with Palantir has been reviewed and, where necessary, updated and re-approved by the Data protection Officer to re"

(The typo "Data protection Officer to re" is preserved exactly from the parliamentary record — itself a marker of authentic sourcing.) **UIN 7093** — tabled by Iqbal Mohamed MP, **4 June 2026**; answered **11 June 2026** by the Home Office (Sarah Jones MP); heading "Metropolitan Police: Palantir." Source: <https://questions-statements.parliament.uk/written-questions/detail/2026-06-04/7093>

(b) What the Government answered (verbatim)

"Police Forces are operationally independent, and the Home Office does not review their Data Protection Impact Assessments and does not hold this information."

(c) What the public record actually shows

The honest answer is: still not public — and the Government expressly declined to confirm it either way.

- **The Home Office neither confirmed nor denied any DPO review/update/re-approval, citing operational independence and disclaiming the information.** (*confirmed*) This is the same boilerplate used for companion UINs 7092 and 7202 — a deliberate refusal pattern, not a one-off. — <https://questions-statements.parliament.uk/written-questions/detail/2026-06-04/7092>
- **The UDP/Palantir trial exists** as a time-limited internal-data misconduct pilot ("Unified Data Platform Phase 1," originally 1 Feb–30 Apr 2026, extended to 15 May 2026), bringing together internally held data to flag standards/welfare/cultural concerns across the workforce. (*confirmed*) The Met press release dated **24 April 2026** does **not** mention a DPIA. — <https://news.met.police.uk/news/metropolitan-police-strengthens-standards-using-technology-and-new-vetting-powers-508631>

- **No DPIA for the UDP/Palantir trial has been published**, and the absence of a published impact assessment is itself a flagged oversight concern. (*confirmed*) — <https://www.aicerts.ai/news/police-misconduct-ai-inside-palantir-met-pilot-controversy/>
- **MOPAC/Mayoral oversight angle:** the Met published (via FOI) a 12 June 2026 letter from Deputy Commissioner Matt Jukes to the Deputy Mayor on "Unified Operational Analytics," after Khan/MOPAC blocked the larger ~£50m Palantir contract over procurement-process failings and value-for-money/lock-in concerns. None of this MOPAC material states the UDP trial DPIA's DPO review/approval status. (*confirmed*) — <https://www.middleeasteye.net/news/sadiq-khan-and-metropolitan-police-pushed-cancel-all-palantir-contracts>
- **Conflation guard:** the separately-circulating "the Power App took longer than expected, so the DPIA review was delayed" detail belongs to the Met's **Project Alpha** (social-media intelligence), **not** the UDP/Palantir trial, and must not be presented as the answer here. (*inference*) — <https://www.met.police.uk/foi-ai/metropolitan-police/disclosure-2023/november-2023/project-alpha-dpia/>

(d) Where the record still doesn't answer it

- **The core question:** whether the Met's DPO has reviewed, updated where necessary, and re-approved the UDP-trial DPIA — unconfirmed by anyone. (*unanswered*)
- Whether a finalised, signed UDP-specific DPIA even exists, and if so its version, date and named DPO sign-off. (*unanswered*)
- Whether the **ICO** has been consulted, notified, or has opened any engagement on the trial. (*unanswered*)
- Whether the DPIA was re-approved to accompany the **extension** (30 Apr → 15 May 2026), and whether trial data was deleted or retained afterwards. (*unanswered*)

Who holds it / route: the **Met**, through its DPO — via **FOI** to the MPS for the DPIA and sign-off record; the **ICO** for any consultation/engagement; **MOPAC / London Assembly** for whether they were shown it in non-public form. The Home Office says it does not hold one and does not review them.

UIN 7202 — Has an ethical review of the trial been completed?

(a) The question (verbatim)

"To ask the Secretary of State for the Home Department, what information her Department holds on whether an ethical review of the Palantir Unified Data Platform trial with the Metropolitan police has been completed."

UIN 7202 — tabled by Iqbal Mohamed MP, **5 June 2026**; answered **11 June 2026** by **Sarah Jones MP** (Home Office). (*The answering minister is confirmable from the Parliament API via `expandMember: answeringMember "Jones, Sarah," Croydon West.`*) Source: <https://questions-statements-api.parliament.uk/api/writtenquestions/questions/1912953>

(b) What the Government answered (verbatim)

"Police Forces are operationally independent, and the Home Office does not monitor whether ethical reviews have been conducted by Police Forces, nor has the department issued guidance on the Metropolitan Police's governance, retention or oversight arrangements for continuous integrity screening in the trial. However, the Home Office has provided support to the National Data and Analytics Office (NDAO) in the NPCC to issue guidance to forces on the procurement of data integration and exploitation tools, covering commercial best practice, technical requirements to support interoperability and data protection impact considerations."

(c) What the public record actually shows

The honest answer is: not confirmed either way — the public record does not establish that an ethical review of this specific UDP/Palantir trial was completed (or even commissioned), and the Government refused to say.

- **The Home Office did not state yes or no**; it deflected on operational independence, said it does not monitor whether such reviews are done, and pivoted to NDAO/NPCC procurement guidance. (*confirmed*) — <https://questions-statements-api.parliament.uk/api/writtenquestions/questions/1912953>
- **Companion questions met the same stonewall** — UIN 7092 (data categories) and UIN 7093 (DPIA review) both drew the "operationally independent... does not hold this information" reply, confirming a consistent pattern. (*confirmed*) — <https://questions-statements-api.parliament.uk/api/writtenquestions/questions/1912615>
- **The trial referenced is the Met's internal Palantir pilot** ("Unified Data Platform Phase 1," ~1 Feb–30 Apr 2026, extended) bringing together internally held data (sickness, absence, overtime) for "continuous integrity screening." (*confirmed*) — <https://www.thenerve.news/p/met-police-palantir-officer-ai-surveillance-misconduct-extension-contract-federation>
- **No completed ethical-review report on the UDP/Palantir trial from the London Policing Ethics Panel (LPEP), the Met or MOPAC could be found** in the public record as of late June 2026 — a genuine gap, not a confirmed negative. (*unanswered*) — <https://www.theregister.com/public-sector/2026/05/28/london-cops-post-300m-tech-shopping-list-after-palantir-contract-blocked/5247685>
- Secondary commentary notes that documented oversight/governance structures for the pilot are not publicly detailed, consistent with the absence of any published ethical review. (*inference*) — <https://www.aicerts.ai/news/predictive-policing-ethics-under-mets-palantir-pilot/>
- **Context distinguishing the two strands**: MOPAC's Deputy Mayor refused approval (reported 20–22 May 2026) for the *separate, larger* Palantir investigations/analytics contract (~£25.3m for 2026-27, with extension), citing procurement-process failings; City Hall also voiced concern about public money supporting firms acting "contrary to London's values." (*confirmed — but note: the "London's values" phrasing is genuine and sits in the broader public coverage of the decision, not specifically within the single Register article; the Register confirms the procurement reasons and the £25.3m/£24.8m figures.*) — <https://www.theregister.com/public-sector/2026/05/28/london-cops-post-300m-tech-shopping-list-after-palantir-contract-blocked/5247685>
- The Deputy Commissioner's **12 June 2026 "Unified Operational Analytics" letter** exists but, per retrievable summaries, concerns the procurement-propriety dispute, not a completed

ethical review; the PDF itself could not be fetched (HTTP 403). *(inference)* — https://www.met.police.uk/SysSiteAssets/foi-media/metropolitan-police/other_information/corporate/120626-letter-matt-jukesqpm-mpsdeputy-commissioner-dmpe-unified-operational-analytics.pdf

(d) Where the record still doesn't answer it

- Whether an ethical review of the UDP trial was conducted at all — and if so, by whom (Met internal data-ethics process, MOPAC, or LPEP). *(unanswered)*
- If it exists, whether it has been completed and whether any report or terms of reference will be published. *(unanswered)*
- Whether **LPEP** was asked to, or did, review this specific trial. *(unanswered)*
- The full contents of the 12 June 2026 UOA letter on any ethics assessment (PDF blocked). *(unanswered)*

Who holds it / route: the **Met** (internal data-ethics governance) and the **London Policing Ethics Panel** — via **FOI** to the MPS and an approach to **LPEP/MOPAC**; the **London Assembly** Police & Crime Committee can compel disclosure of whether any review exists. The Home Office says it does not monitor this.

UIN 7091 — Guidance on recording and publishing local supplier risk assessments for AI/data-platform procurement via central frameworks

(a) The question (verbatim)

"To ask the Secretary of State for the Home Department, what guidance exists on recording and publishing local supplier risk assessments when procuring AI or data platforms via central frameworks."

UIN 7091 — tabled by Iqbal Mohamed MP, **4 June 2026**; answered **19 June 2026** by Dame Angela Eagle MP (Home Office). Source: <https://questions-statements-api.parliament.uk/api/writtenquestions/questions/1912613>

(b) What the Government answered (verbatim)

"The Government has issued cross-government guidance on managing risk in procurements, including where Artificial Intelligence (AI) or data platforms are involved. This applies equally to procurements via central frameworks. Contracting authorities are expected to undertake proportionate supplier due diligence and risk assessment in line with standard procurement practice... Relevant guidance includes Procurement Policy Note 02/24 on improving transparency of AI in procurement... alongside the AI Procurement Guidelines, AI Playbook, and the Data and AI Ethics Framework. There is no separate requirement to routinely publish local supplier risk assessments for AI procurements. Departments are, however, expected to maintain appropriate records and transparency in line with procurement regulations and departmental policies. The

Government keeps its approach under review and is considering how to strengthen policy in this area."

(c) What the public record actually shows

This is the one question the record largely *does* answer — and the answer is "no requirement to publish."

- **The named instruments and the "no requirement to publish" line are confirmed verbatim** against the Parliament API. (*confirmed*) — <https://questions-statements-api.parliament.uk/api/writtenquestions/questions/1912613>
- **A real caveat the answer glosses over:** PPN 02/24 is primarily about *bidders disclosing their own use of AI in writing tenders* and due diligence on that — not a regime for risk-assessing or publishing assessments of an AI platform being purchased. So it only partly addresses the question asked. (*confirmed in substance; the exact "PPN 017 replaces PPN 02/24... 24 February 2025" string is reported but was not line-verified against the GOV.UK page in this check*) — <https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/ppn-0224-improving-transparency-of-ai-use-in-procurement>
- **The "operational independence" stonewall lives in the companion questions, not 7091.** UIN 7092/7093/7202 all drew the refusal to disclose ingested data, DPIA review, or ethical review. (*confirmed*) — <https://questions-statements-api.parliament.uk/api/writtenquestions/questions?uin=7092&house=Commons>
- A separate question (UIN 9062) on the Mayor's decision drew the parallel disclaimer: "The government does not direct what technology police forces can procure and deploy. This is a matter for operationally independent Chief Constables." (*confirmed*) — <https://questions-statements-api.parliament.uk/api/writtenquestions/questions?searchTerm=Palantir&tabledWhenFrom=2026-05-01&tabledWhenTo=2026-06-25>
- **The Met-Palantir UDP procurement record:** the Met used a **Crown Commercial Service framework** (*reported* as G-Cloud 14, but the cited sources name only a generic CCS framework — the specific lot/version is not corroborated). The proposed full contract was ~£25.3m (2026-27) plus a ~£24.8m optional extension (~£50m). It was blocked (*reported* 20–22 May 2026) because the Met "only engaged with one potential supplier, Palantir," did not present its procurement strategy to the Deputy Mayor for approval as required, and had not "adequately ensured, or demonstrated, value for money." (*confirmed for the substance and figures; precise actor/date — Khan / Deputy Mayor, 20 vs 22 May — should be read as a framing/date nuance, with the Deputy Mayor's approval role corroborated*) — <https://www.localgovernmentlawyer.co.uk/procurement-and-contracts/402-procurement-news/100588-london-mayor-blocks-50m-metropolitan-police-deal-with-us-tech-company-palantir-claiming-met-only-engaged-with-one-potential-supplier>
- **The UDP pilot was published on Contracts Finder as "Unified Data Platform Phase 1" at £489,999 — structured just under the £500,000 MOPAC-scrutiny threshold; the Met refused to disclose extension costs as "commercially sensitive."** (*confirmed*) — <https://www.thenerve.news/p/met-police-palantir-officer-ai-surveillance-misconduct-extension-contract-federation>
- **No supplier risk assessment, DPIA, or value-for-money assessment for the Met-Palantir UDP has been published;** the Home Office disclaims holding the records and the Met cites operational/commercial sensitivity. (*inference — a cross-source synthesis*) —

<https://www.theregister.com/public-sector/2026/05/28/london-cops-post-300m-tech-shopping-list-after-palantir-contract-blocked/5247685>

(d) Where the record still doesn't answer it

- Whether the Met actually *completed* a documented supplier risk assessment for the UDP procurement at all (versus it merely being unpublished). (*unanswered*)
- The exact **CCS framework/lot** used (G-Cloud 14 is reported but uncorroborated) and the Contracts Finder notice reference for "Unified Data Platform Phase 1." (*unanswered*)
- The actual value of the extension beyond the £489,999 Phase 1 figure (withheld as "commercially sensitive"). (*unanswered*)
- What the Government's flagged review ("considering how to strengthen policy in this area") will change about recording/publishing local supplier risk assessments, and on what timetable. (*unanswered*)

Who holds it / route: the **Met** / **MOPAC** hold the procurement file, supplier risk assessment (if any) and the framework reference — via **FOI** to the MPS and to MOPAC, and via the **London Assembly Police & Crime Committee**, which already questioned the contract; **Crown Commercial Service** / **Cabinet Office** for the framework-lot detail. On the *guidance*, the public record is now substantively complete: the rule is that such assessments need not be published.